

6.1.2 Supply Process

6.1.2.1 Purpose

The purpose of the Supply Process is to provide a product or service to the acquirer that meets the agreed requirements. This includes responding to acquisition requests, establishing agreements, executing the contract, delivering and supporting the product or service, and closing the contractual relationship.

6.1.2.2 Outcomes

As a result of successful implementation of the Supply Process:

- a) The acquirer and their requirements are identified.
 - b) A response is produced to the acquirer's request (e.g., proposal, bid).
 - c) An agreement is established with the acquirer for developing, maintaining, operating, packaging, delivering, and installing the product or service.
 - d) The product or service is developed and/or provided in accordance with the agreed requirements.
 - e) The product or service is delivered and, if required, installed in accordance with the agreed requirements.
 - f) The contractual relationship is successfully concluded, with responsibilities transferred to the acquirer.
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6.1.2.3 Activities and Tasks

The supplier shall perform the following activities and tasks in accordance with organizational policies and applicable standards.

6.1.2.3.1 Opportunity Identification

This activity involves identifying potential acquirers and understanding their needs.

- 6.1.2.3.1.1 Identify the existence and identity of an acquirer who has a need for a product or service.
- 6.1.2.3.1.2 Collect relevant information regarding the acquirer's needs, environment, and constraints.

6.1.2.3.2 Supplier Tendering

This activity involves analyzing the acquirer's request and preparing a formal response.

- 6.1.2.3.2.1 Review the requirements in the request for proposal, taking into account organizational policies, capabilities, and applicable regulations.
- 6.1.2.3.2.2 Decide whether to bid or accept the contract.
- 6.1.2.3.2.3 Prepare and submit a proposal or tender in response to the acquirer's request.

6.1.2.3.3 Contract Agreement

This activity establishes the formal agreement between the supplier and acquirer.

- 6.1.2.3.3.1 Negotiate and establish an agreement covering development, maintenance, operation, packaging, delivery, and installation of the product or service.
- 6.1.2.3.3.2 Ensure that the contract reflects applicable requirements for quality, performance, schedule, proprietary rights, and regulatory compliance.

6.1.2.3.4 Contract Execution

This activity involves executing the contract, which includes planning, development, operation, and maintenance.

6.1.2.3.4.1 Project Planning

The supplier shall review the acquisition requirements to define a framework for managing and assuring the project and the quality of the deliverable. This should use an organizationally defined life cycle model. The supplier shall:

- Establish requirements for project management and quality assurance plans, including resource needs and acquirer involvement.
- Evaluate development options and associated risks, including:
 - a) Internal development
 - b) Subcontracting
 - c) Procuring off-the-shelf software
 - d) Combinations of the above
- Develop and document project management plans covering:

- Organizational structure, roles, responsibilities
- Engineering and test environments
- Resources, size, schedule
- Quality characteristics and quality plans (7.2.3)
- Safety and security plans
- Subcontractor management
- Verification (7.2.4) and Validation (7.2.5) approach
- Acquirer and user involvement (7.2.6, 7.2.7)
- Risk management
- Security policy (need-to-know, access control)
- Approval and certification requirements
- Scheduling, tracking, and reporting methods
- Personnel training (6.2.4)

6.1.2.3.4.2 Development

The supplier shall develop the software product in accordance with the Technical Processes (6.4), including:

- Implementation (6.4.5)
- System/Software Integration (6.4.6 / 7.1.6)
- Qualification Testing (6.4.7 / 7.1.7)

6.1.2.3.4.3 Operation and Maintenance

The supplier shall:

- Operate the software product in accordance with the Software Operation Process (6.4.9).
- Maintain the software product in accordance with the Software Maintenance Process (6.4.10).

6.1.2.3.4.4 Subcontractor Management

The supplier shall manage and control subcontractors in accordance with the Acquisition Process (6.1.1), passing down all contractual requirements to ensure compliance with prime contract obligations.

6.1.2.3.4.5 Verification, Validation, and Quality Assurance

The supplier shall:

- Perform quality assurance in accordance with 7.2.3.
- Perform verification and validation according to 7.2.4 and 7.2.5 to demonstrate that products and services meet their requirements.
- Provide evaluation, review, audit, and test reports to the acquirer as specified in the contract.

6.1.2.3.4.6 Acquirer and Third-Party Interfaces

The supplier shall interface with the acquirer, independent verification/validation agents, and other parties as specified in the contract and project plans. This includes:

- Coordinating contract review activities, communication, and interfaces.
- Conducting or supporting reviews (7.2.6), audits (7.2.7), acceptance testing, and joint reviews with the acquirer.

6.1.2.3.4.7 Monitoring and Control

The supplier shall monitor and control the progress and quality of the software products or services throughout the contracted life cycle. This includes:

- Monitoring technical performance, costs, schedules, and status reporting.
 - Identifying, recording, analyzing, and resolving problems.
 - Tracking subcontractor performance and ensuring compliance with contractual obligations.
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6.1.2.3.5 Product/Service Delivery and Support

This activity involves delivering and, if required, installing the product or service.

- 6.1.2.3.5.1 Deliver the software product or service in accordance with the contract.
 - 6.1.2.3.5.2 Provide the acquirer with required access to supplier and subcontractor facilities for review as specified.
 - 6.1.2.3.5.3 Install the product, if required by the agreement.
 - 6.1.2.3.5.4 Assist the acquirer with the delivered product or service as specified.
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6.1.2.3.6 Closure

This activity concludes the contract.

- 6.1.2.3.6.1 Accept and acknowledge payment or other agreed consideration.
- 6.1.2.3.6.2 Transfer responsibility for the product or service to the acquirer.
- 6.1.2.3.6.3 Address terms and authorization for initiating closure as defined in the agreement.